

Team & Collaborator Access — Developer Spec

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Overview

This spec adds Team Member and Collaborator access to PlanTelligence: reusable person profiles, plan- and category-scoped assignments, preset and Custom roles, seat tracking, and collaborator upgrade previews. Build in the order below; T1 and T2 are the foundation and nothing else ships without them.

Order	Ticket	Priority
1	T1: Data model: profiles, companies, assignments	Must Have
2	T2: Permission enforcement layer	Must Have
3	T2a: Custom role with plan-first grid	Medium
4	T3: Team Member management + seat counter	Must Have
5	T4: Invite Collaborator from Create Benefits	Must Have
6	T5: Key Contacts entry point	Must Have
7	T6: Assignment management screen	Must Have
8	T7: Benefits Hub contact display	Must Have
9	T8: Collaborator gating + upgrade previews	Medium (deferred pending pricing)

Each ticket has two parts: **Part A: UI** (screens and flow) and **Part B: Logic** (data, rules, enforcement), followed by acceptance criteria. Status values follow the Part 2 punch list: Open, In Progress, Ready for Review, Accepted, Deferred. All tickets start Open.

Guiding principle: **create the person once, reuse the profile, manage plan and category assignments separately**. The system pre-fills the most likely choice based on where the user is working; the user can always widen or narrow access afterward.

Core Concepts

User types

	Team Member	Collaborator
Who	Internal to the advisor's organization: assistant, paraplanner, service associate, co-advisor, compliance	External: plan sponsor HR, outside benefits advisor, TPA, recordkeeper contact, provider rep
Created from	Onboarding or Settings → Team	Inside a plan: Create Benefits or Key Contacts
Seat	Uses a paid seat	Free; counts toward a per-plan collaborator cap
Plan scope	This Plan, Certain Plans, or All Plans	This Plan or Certain Plans (no All Plans)
Can publish, invite, delete, see billing or org settings	Depends on role	Never

Email-domain guess: a domain matching the organization defaults to Team Member; any other domain defaults to Collaborator. The user can override.

Profile vs. assignment

- **Profile** = who the person and their company are. Created once, reused everywhere.
- **Assignment** = which plan and categories they're connected to, with what role, and whether they're shown on the hub. One record per person per plan.

Example: Jane Smith (ABC Benefits) has one profile and three assignments: Ayres → Group Health, Precision Optical → Group Health, Air Fayre → Group Life.

Carries across plans: name, job title, designation, email, phone, headshot, benefits specialty, company, company logo and branding.

Never carries across plans: plan documents, plan IDs, group numbers, provider login URLs, meetings, marketing assets, plan-specific messaging, plan-specific benefit details.

Profile states

State	Login	Counts toward cap	How it's reached
Contact	No	No	"Complete Profile Myself"
Invited	Pending	Yes (Team Members reserve a seat)	Invite sent
Active	Yes	Yes	Invite accepted

A Contact can be upgraded to Invited at any time; the profile stays the same.

Roles

Role	For	Can do
Owner	Team Member	Everything, including billing and ownership transfer
Admin	Team Member	Everything except billing; can publish and invite
Editor	Team Member	Create and edit within scope; cannot publish, delete plans, or see billing
Contributor	Collaborator	Edit assigned categories only; marks sections "Ready for Review"
Viewer / Reviewer	Both	Read-only; can comment or approve
Custom	Both	Function-by-function access (see T2a); collaborator hard limits still apply

T1: Data Model: Profiles, Companies, Assignments

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

None. Backend only.

Part B: Logic

1. **Person Profile** (scoped to the User Organization)

- Fields: name, job title, designation, email, phone, headshot, benefits specialty.
- Type: Team Member or Collaborator.
- State: Contact, Invited, or Active.
- Linked Partner Company (optional for Team Members).

2. **Partner Company** (scoped to the User Organization)

- Fields: name, logo, branding.
- Entity type: Partner/Provider. Must never appear in Plan Sponsor pickers.
- One company can have many profiles.

3. **Assignment** (one record per person per plan)

- Profile, plan.
- Category scope: all categories, or a list of selected categories.
- Role: Owner, Admin, Editor, Viewer, Contributor, Reviewer, or Custom.
- Permission set: the full function-level grid (see T2a). Presets write their default grid; Custom writes the edited grid.
- "Show on Benefits Hub" toggle.
- Invited by, invited on, last changed by, last changed on.

4. **Org-level "All Plans" flag** on Team Member profiles. When set, an assignment is generated automatically for every new plan.

5. **Login linking:** email links a profile to one global login. A person who collaborates with two User Organizations has two separate profiles and one login.

6. **Plan-specific data stays plan-scoped.** Documents, plan IDs, group numbers, provider URLs, meetings, marketing assets, and messaging never attach to the profile.

Acceptance

- Jane holds assignments on three plans from one profile.
- Editing Jane's profile in Org A does not change her profile in Org B.
- Partner companies never appear in Plan Sponsor search.
- Two collaborators from ABC Benefits share one company record.

T2: Permission Enforcement Layer

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

- Hide or disable controls the user doesn't have permission for.
- A user who reaches a restricted page directly sees "You don't have access to this plan/section" with a link back to the dashboard.

Part B: Logic

1. **Every read and write is checked at the API layer, not only in the UI.** Each request is validated against plan, category, and the assignment's permission set.
2. **Collaborators never** publish, delete, invite, view billing or org settings, or see unassigned plans. This is a hard rule, including for Custom roles.
3. **Signed URLs for documents and media check the assignment** before they're issued.
4. **At least one Owner** must always exist on an organization.

Acceptance

- A Contributor on Ayres → Group Health cannot open Ayres → Retirement or any other plan, through the UI or the API.
- A Viewer cannot save edits.
- A signed document URL is refused to an unassigned user.

T2a: Custom Role (Plan-First Grid)

Priority: Medium · **Status:** Open · **Sequence:** after T2, before T6

No schema change is needed: T1 already stores one assignment per person per plan, so "same permissions on all plans" writes identical records and per-plan customization writes different ones.

Part A: UI

The Custom role screen runs top to bottom in three steps. It starts from the closest preset (the person's current role), never blank.

Step 1: Plans

1. Pre-filled with the current plan (e.g. Ayres).
2. **" + Add plans"** opens a searchable checklist.
3. **"All Plans"** is shown for Team Members only. It is hidden for Collaborators (see Open Decisions).
4. Choosing All Plans shows: "Includes plans created in the future."

Step 2: Benefits Categories

1. Pre-filled with the current category (e.g. Group Health).
2. **"Same categories on all plans"** checkbox, on by default.
3. When off, show a category picker per plan (plans have different active categories).

Step 3: Functions

1. **"Same permissions on all selected plans"** toggle, on by default.
2. When off, each plan gets its own tab with its own grid. New tabs copy the first plan's settings.
3. Each function is a row of radio buttons:

Function	Options
Plan Details & Branding	No Access / View / Edit
Create Benefits (within category scope)	No Access / View / Edit
Key Contacts	No Access / View / Edit
Documents	No Access / View / Edit
Meetings	No Access / View / Edit
Marketing	No Access / View / Edit
Video	No Access / View / Edit
Disclaimers / Compliance	No Access / View / Edit
Benefits Hub Preview	No Access / View
Publish	Not Allowed / Allowed
Invite Team or Collaborators	Not Allowed / Allowed
Delete (content, plans)	Not Allowed / Allowed

Function	Options
Org Settings	No Access / View / Edit
Billing	No Access / View / Edit

- 4. Locked rows for Collaborators:** Publish, Invite, Delete, Org Settings, and Billing show a lock icon and "Not available for external collaborators."
- 5. Plan-aware summary line** under the name, e.g. "Custom · Edits Documents on Ayres · Views Precision Optical."
- 6. Warnings appear inline** as selections are made, and again on Save as one confirm listing everything flagged.

Part B: Logic

1. What the invitee type allows

	This Plan	+ Add Plans	All Plans
Team Member	Yes	Yes	Yes
Collaborator	Yes	Yes	No

2. Auto-enforced rules (applied silently)

- Edit on a function turns on View for it.
- Delete requires Edit on the same function.
- Publish requires View on all categories in the plan, plus View on Disclaimers.

3. Hard blocks (cannot be overridden)

- Collaborators cannot be given Publish, Invite, Delete, Org Settings, or Billing, including by direct API call.
- All Plans is disabled when per-plan tabs are on (new plans have no tab to copy from).

4. Soft warnings (user confirms and proceeds). Checked per plan.

Condition	Warning text
Collaborator with Edit on 2+ plans	"This external collaborator can edit multiple plans. Collaborators usually work on one plan."
Collaborator added to 3+ plans	"This collaborator is assigned to 3+ plans. Consider a Team Member seat if they work with you regularly."
Collaborator with Edit on all categories in a plan	"This collaborator can edit every benefits category. Most are limited to their specialty."
Selected category isn't active on an added plan	"Group Health isn't set up on Precision Optical yet. Access will apply once it's added."
Per-plan permissions differ widely	"Access varies significantly between plans. Review before saving."
Team Member with Billing but not Owner/Admin	"Billing access is usually limited to Owners."
Marketing Edit without Meetings View	"Marketing assets pull meeting details. This user won't see them."
Publish Allowed with No Access on Documents or Marketing	"This user can publish content they can't review."
Edit assigned to a hidden category	"This category is hidden on the Benefits Hub."
Custom settings match a preset exactly	"This matches [Editor]. Use the preset instead?"

5. Save and audit

- Store the full permission set on each assignment, never a reference to a preset. Changing a preset later must not alter Custom users.
- Log who set Custom access, when, and which warnings were confirmed.

Acceptance

- An invite from Ayres → Group Health opens with Ayres and Group Health pre-selected.

- A Custom user with Documents Edit and everything else View can upload documents and cannot save changes in any other module, through the UI or the API.
- Adding Precision Optical with "same permissions" on creates two identical assignments.
- With "same permissions" off, Edit on Ayres and View on Precision Optical are enforced independently.
- Locked rows cannot be enabled for a Collaborator, including by direct API call.
- All Plans never appears for a Collaborator.
- A Team Member with All Plans automatically gets access to a newly created plan.
- Each soft warning fires on its condition, and Save completes after confirmation.
- An Owner can see which warnings were confirmed on any Custom assignment.

Optional (Low): "Save as role template" so a firm can reuse a setup such as "Enrollment Assistant."

T3: Team Member Management + Seat Counter

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

1. **Settings → Team** lists all Team Members with role, plan access, category access, and status.
2. **Add Team Member form:** name and email, role, plan access (This Plan / Certain Plans / All Plans), benefits access (All / Certain). Default: All Plans + All Categories.
3. **Seat meter:** "X of Y seats used," with pending invites shown separately. Visible in Settings → Team and on the dashboard.
4. **Invite step in onboarding.** The owner is pre-filled as the first member; the step can be skipped.

Part B: Logic

1. **Only Team Members use seats.** Contacts and Collaborators do not.
2. **Pending invites reserve a seat** and release automatically after 14 days.
3. **At the seat limit, show an upgrade confirm, not a hard block.** Only an Owner or Admin can confirm. Tier logic stays a placeholder until pricing is final.

4. **Email-domain guess:** a domain matching the organization defaults the invitee to Team Member.

Acceptance

- An invite fills a seat; an expired invite releases it.
- Onboarding completes whether or not the team step is skipped.
- The owner appears as the first Team Member after onboarding.

T4: Invite Collaborator from Create Benefits

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

1. **"Invite Collaborator" button on each category card**, next to Edit.
2. **The dialog pre-fills plan and category from context.** An invite from Ayres → Group Health is scoped to exactly that; the user is not asked again.
3. **Fields:**
 - Email
 - "Who is this?": Plan Sponsor HR, Outside Advisor/Specialist, Provider Rep, Reviewer only
 - Optional note and due date
4. **"Customize access" link** expands to the plan-first grid from T2a.
5. **"Add Existing Collaborator" search** by person or company name. Selecting a result fills in the saved profile and company branding.
6. **The card shows the assignment:** avatar plus status, e.g. "Assigned to Jane · 3 fields missing."

Part B: Logic

1. **"Who is this?" maps to presets:** Plan Sponsor HR, Outside Advisor/Specialist, and Provider Rep → Contributor; Reviewer only → Reviewer.
2. **The domain guess pre-selects the answer:** a plan sponsor domain suggests Plan Sponsor HR.
3. **The invite email deep-links to the assigned section** and lists the missing fields.
4. **"Ready for Review" notifies the inviter**, who can Approve or Send Back.

5. **If the email matches an existing profile in this org, reuse it** instead of creating a duplicate.

Acceptance

- An invite from Ayres → Group Health creates an assignment for exactly that plan and category.
- A second invite to Jane on another plan adds an assignment, not a new profile.
- The deep link opens the correct section.
- Approve and Send Back both notify the collaborator.

T5: Key Contacts Entry Point

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

1. **Two options in Create Plan → Key Contacts:**
 - **Complete Profile Myself:** saves immediately as a Contact, no login required.
 - **Invite Collaborator to Complete Profile:** sends an invite.
2. **Scope:** defaults to This Plan; the user picks the categories.
3. **"Add Existing Contact / Collaborator" search** by person or company name.
4. **"Invite to collaborate" action** on any existing Contact.

Part B: Logic

1. **State changes:** a Contact has no login and doesn't count toward any cap. Inviting upgrades it to Invited, then Active on acceptance.
2. **Profile ownership:** once Active, the collaborator controls their own individual info. The advisor controls assignments and display.
3. **Companies created here are reusable** across all profiles in the organization.

Acceptance

- A contact created with Complete Profile Myself appears on the hub with no invite sent.
- Upgrading that Contact to a Collaborator keeps the same profile.
- Two collaborators from ABC Benefits share one company record.

T6: Assignment Management Screen

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

1. **Per-person screen:** profile at top, assignments listed below by plan.
2. **Plan access:** This Plan / Certain Plans (searchable checklist) / All Plans (Team Members only).
3. **Benefits access:** All / Certain categories, with the current category pre-checked.
4. **Per-assignment controls:** role dropdown (presets + Custom, which opens the T2a grid) and "Show on Benefits Hub" toggle.
5. **Three separate actions:** Remove Assignment, Deactivate, Delete Profile.

Part B: Logic

1. **Remove Assignment:** access to that plan or category ends immediately.
2. **Deactivate:** all access to the organization ends; the profile is kept.
3. **Delete Profile:** allowed only when the person has no remaining assignments.
4. **Content the person created is never deleted** by any of these actions.
5. **Every change is logged** with who and when.

Acceptance

- Adding Jane to Precision Optical takes one screen.
- A removed assignment revokes access on the next request.
- A deactivated user cannot log in to that organization.
- Delete Profile is blocked while assignments remain.

T7: Benefits Hub Contact Display

Priority: Must Have · **Status:** Open

Part A: UI

1. **Assigned people with display on appear in two places:** My Benefits Team, and the relevant category page.
2. **Each listing shows** headshot, name, title, designation, company logo, email, and phone.

Part B: Logic

1. **The hub renders from profile + assignment.** One source of truth; contact details are never duplicated.
2. **Display off:** the person doesn't appear on the hub but keeps their admin access.
3. **Hidden categories** don't render their contacts.

Acceptance

- Jane on Ayres → Group Health appears in both places on the Ayres hub and nowhere on other hubs.
- With display off, she disappears from the hub but can still edit.
- Updating Jane's phone number in her profile updates every hub she appears on.

T8: Collaborator Gating + Upgrade Previews

Priority: Medium · **Status:** Deferred pending pricing

The goal is converting collaborators into paying users. Collaborators get a generous cap even on the basic plan, and they see gated features rather than hidden ones.

Part A: UI

1. **Locked-but-visible features:** Create Plan, Create Marketing Asset, and applying templates or images outside the assigned plan.
2. **A locked feature opens an upgrade screen** tailored to the collaborator type:
 - Outside Advisor/Specialist → "Build hubs for your own clients"
 - Plan Sponsor HR → "Invite your other advisors"
 - Provider Rep → a light "Learn more"
3. **"Preview your branded hub"** for Outside Advisors: generates a non-publishable preview with their own logo and branding (uses the WEP pipeline once built).

Part B: Logic

1. **Collaborator caps per plan are configurable values**, not hard-coded. Placeholder: 10 Contributors and unlimited Reviewers per plan.
2. **Track upgrade-screen views and clicks** to measure conversion.

3. **Converting a collaborator into a paying customer** creates a new User Organization. Their collaborator profile in the original organization is unchanged.

Acceptance

- Locked actions show the correct upgrade screen for each collaborator type.
- Caps can be changed without a deploy.
- A converted collaborator keeps working in the original organization's plans.

Open Decisions

These must be settled before T3 and T8 can close. The tickets use the stated default until then.

Decision	Current default	Blocks
Collaborator cap numbers per tier	10 Contributors, unlimited Reviewers per plan	T8
Tier breakpoints and pricing	Placeholder upgrade confirm at seat limit	T3, T8
Can Editors invite Collaborators?	No: Owner/Admin only	T4, T5
Is approval required after "Ready for Review" before a section counts as Complete?	Optional	T4
Can Owners/Admins grant All Plans to a Collaborator, with a warning?	No	T2a, T6